had diabetes, he fought it by becoming a marathoner. This not only improved his fitness but developed several qualities in him. He became more patient, disciplined and observant. It transformed him into a long-term player, as he says.

Like Ratan, Chandrasekaran was no stranger to the Tata Group. Both had risen to the top after decades of working in it. Chandrasekaran's thirty-year tenure in TCS was momentous. Since September 2007, he had also worked as COO of the company, with Ratan as the chairman. Two years later, he was appointed as the CEO and MD after S. Ramadorai stepped down from the position.

Both knew each other well, their relationship particularly strengthening after Chandrasekaran succeeded Ramadorai. Explaining how he scheduled his weekly meetings with Ratan, Chandrasekaran says that every Wednesday, lunchtime would be 'soft-blocked'. The two would discuss important issues relating to TCS. The meetings were strategic. Ratan did not micromanage the company; he only looked at the big picture, says Chandrasekaran. These interactions, besides affording an opportunity to Ratan to get to know Chandrasekaran, also gave him a closer view of the latter's performance and how, as a leading business newspaper wrote in 2017, 'Chandra helped turn software maker Tata Consultancy Services Ltd. into a growth machine, boosting market value by more than 10 times since 2009.'

In the aftermath of the 2008 global financial crisis, Chandrasekaran had transformed the company into a profitable venture and eventually built it into the most valued Indian IT company. During his tenure, 2009–16, TCS recorded a staggering CAGR of over 21 and 24 per cent in topline and PAT respectively. These were carefully noted by Ratan.

Even after Ratan's retirement in 2012, Chandrasekaran would regularly brief him about the company's functioning and performance. In his view, as the chairman of Tata Trusts, the largest shareholder of Tata Sons, Ratan had the right to be briefed within the framework of good governance on the health and the affairs of the company.

Confluencing Approach

In many respects, Chandrasekaran thinks like Ratan. During his long years at TCS, he imbibed some of the fundamental principles and ethos that have